

PROJECT REPORT

Omm Anshuman Jena

25BAI10437

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INTRODUCTION

This project was undertaken as part of the **CSE0001 - Digital Literacy** course at **VIT Bhopal University**. Serving in the role of a **Student Digital Ambassador**, my primary objective was to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that guides peers through the complexities of the modern digital landscape. The project is structured across five core modules, ranging from visual communication and professional portfolio building to coding collaboration, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness.

By creating a centralized **GitHub repository**, I have documented my journey in establishing a professional online presence and mastering essential digital tools. This report serves as a formal reflection on those tasks, highlighting the importance of communicating safely and responsibly in an academic and professional environment. As a first-year **B. Tech CSE student**, these foundational skills are critical for my future career in technology.

Task 1 Write-Up

For this task, I designed a “**Digital Literacy Essentials**” infographic using **Canva**. As a Student Digital Ambassador, my aim was to create a visually attractive resource that simplifies complex digital concepts for my peers. The design is divided into three different regions i.e., The definition of Digital Literacy, some of the top digital tools and some instructions on how to stay safe online. I used different tools such as images, type warp, etc. also adding footer and keeping information short and simple.

One thing I found particularly interesting while making this was how much visuals matter in digital communication. Initially, my design was supposed to be text-heavy, with a lot more information on the cards, but I realized that using images such as the brain for cognition and the shield for security, made the message more impactful. The most difficult part was choosing the “**Top Digital Tools**” to showcase, as there are so many useful tools that can be used in different fields. Ultimately, this exercise helped me understand how to communicate technical information responsibly and effectively to a non-technical audience.

Task 2 Write-Up

For this task, I established a professional digital presence by setting up and optimizing profiles on **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle**. I chose these platforms because they form the essential “**digital triad**” for a Computer Science student. **GitHub** serves as my code repository where I host academic projects like my “**VITYARTHI**” crop predictor. **LinkedIn** acts as my professional identity, allowing me to connect with the global academic community and internship coordinators. Finally, I selected **Kaggle** to explore data science datasets and practice the Python-based numerical methods I am learning in my B. Tech CSE modules.

My plan for the next four years is to use these platforms as a living document of my technical growth. I intend to commit code to GitHub weekly to build a consistent contribution graph, which is highly valued by employers. On LinkedIn, I will share certifications and project milestones to stay available for internship opportunities. By maintaining these profiles early in my first year, I am building a foundational portfolio that transitions from a simple student record into a professional identity by graduation.

Task 3 Write-Up

In this task, I explored essential digital tools for technical practice and academic collaboration. For the coding component, I utilized **HackerRank** to complete the basic Python challenge. This exercise was instrumental in familiarizing myself with competitive programming environments, which are vital for my B. Tech CSE journey. Additionally, I used **Google Forms** to design a five-question "Digital Literacy Quick Assessment Quiz" for my peers. This allowed me to practice data collection and cloud-based collaboration by linking the quiz to a **Google Sheet** for real-time response tracking.

These platforms will be central to my academic success over the next four years. HackerRank provides a structured path to improve my problem-solving skills for future technical interviews, while Google Workspace tools enable seamless teamwork on group projects and research. Acting as a Student Digital Ambassador, creating the quiz helped me realize how interactive digital tools can be effective and improve a community's awareness of safe internet practices. Integrating these diverse platforms into my workflow ensures I am prepared for both individual technical challenges and collaborative professional environments.

Task 4 Write-Up

Digital communication is a very important quality in Professional Environment.

One situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem involves a student who sent a demanding, informal email to a professor using slang and no subject line. The professor ignored the email, assuming it was spam, which resulted in the student missing a critical project deadline. This could have been avoided by using a clear subject line, a professional salutation, and a respectful tone. This experience taught me that digital etiquette is not just about politeness—it is about ensuring your message is received, understood, and taken seriously in a professional environment.

Task 5 Write-up

While researching cyberbullying and online safety, I was most surprised by how sophisticated social engineering tactics have become, particularly UPI-based frauds targeting students. It was eye-opening to realize that even tech-savvy individuals can be manipulated into sharing sensitive information through 'urgency' or 'fear.' As a result of this research, I have made it a personal habit to verify every UPI recipient's identity twice and I have enabled biometric locks on all my financial apps. Understanding the official reporting channels like the 1930 helpline has made me feel more confident in my role as a Digital Ambassador, as I can now provide concrete help to my batchmates if they encounter online threats.

CONCLUSION

Completing this Digital Literacy project has been a transformative experience in my first year of engineering. By acting as a **Digital Ambassador**, I have not only learned how to use tools like **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Canva** but also how to teach these skills to others responsibly. I now have a much clearer understanding of how to maintain a professional digital footprint and protect myself from online threats like phishing and cyberbullying. This portfolio will remain a permanent part of my professional identity, serving as a platform for my future growth in the field of Computer Science.

REFERENCES

- **VITYarthi E-Learning Platform:** CSE0001 Course Modules and Project Brief.
- **GitHub:** github.com – Used for project hosting and portfolio README.
- **Canva:** canva.com – Used for creating the Task 1 Digital Literacy Infographic.
- **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com – Used for professional networking and profile setup.
- **HackerRank:** hackerrank.com – Used for completing the Python coding challenge.
- **Google Workspace:** forms.google.com – Used for the Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz.
- **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal:** cybercrime.gov.in – Cited for safety and reporting guidelines.